

Kaden Huynh

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Political Science, Minor in Philosophy

Santa Barbara, CA

Sep 2024 - Jun 2027

- Cumulative GPA: 3.87/4.0 | Honors: Dean's Honor List, National Political Science Honor Society
- Relevant Coursework: Political Theory (Classical, Modern, Contemporary), Government and Politics of Japan

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, UCEAP

Barcelona, Spain

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

- Relevant Coursework: Leadership and Negotiation Techniques, Critical Thinking

International Christian University, UCEAP

Tokyo, Japan

Aug 2026 - Dec 2026

Experience

Pho Ha Grill & Bar

Oceanside, CA

Shift Lead

Dec 2021 – Dec 2025

- Supervised a team of 10+ employees in a fast-paced, customer-oriented environment, developing leadership and operational management qualities while handling thousands of dollars in sales transactions each shift.
- Onboarded 5 new employees on workplace procedures, improving communication and team coordination skills.
- Analyzed metrics across Grubhub, DoorDash, and Uber Eats to identify inefficiencies, implementing UI changes and optimizations that increased online orders by 25%, strengthening data analysis and technical skills.

In-N-Out

San Diego, CA

Associate

Dec 2023 – Aug 2024

- Collaborated with a team of over 30 employees across simultaneous high-volume stations, adapting quickly to shifting operational demands and maintaining efficiency during peak service periods throughout the week.
- Delivered professional service to hundreds of customers per shift while maintaining composure and efficiency.
- Upheld cleanliness standards under health regulations, earning recognition for consistent attention to detail.

Leadership & Activities

Vietnamese Buddhist Youth Association

San Diego, CA

Youth Leader

May 2019 - Present

- Spearheaded community fundraising campaigns through prayers and banquets, generating thousands of dollars in direct relief aid for flood victims across Vietnam and supporting international humanitarian efforts.
- Planned and executed summer camps and weekly meetings for 60+ members, building project management and organizational skills while fostering a sense of community and belonging among youth participants.
- Mentored 30+ children and teenagers through positive role-modeling and Vietnamese language instruction, deepening cultural connection and preserving heritage within the Vietnamese diaspora in San Diego.

National Speech & Debate Association

San Diego, CA

Parliamentary Debater

Aug 2020 - Jun 2024

- Competed in Parliamentary Debate at tournaments across California, earning a varsity performance award against hundreds of peers while directly cultivating advanced argumentation, research, and public speaking skills.
- Researched and prepared cases on a rotating set of resolutions spanning domestic policy, international relations, and ethics, developing the ability to analyze unfamiliar topics quickly and refute complex philosophical arguments.

Projects

Athena

Jun 2026

Web Application | React, Node.js, Supabase, Claude API, Mapbox

- Built a full-stack app that ingests short-form media, web links, and PDFs and uses a Claude API tool call to transcribe, summarize, and classify each item, with a review queue to correct low-confidence results.
- Architected a serverless pipeline on Vercel with a dedicated worker that extracts scene-change video frames and audio for analysis, persisting results in Supabase and rendering geocoded locations on an interactive map.

Skills & Interests

Awards: AP Scholar with Distinction, Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish, SDIVSL Varsity Parliamentary Award

Languages: Fluent in English and Spanish, Proficient in Vietnamese

Technical: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Node.js, Supabase, Tailwind CSS, Vercel